

Muncie Ethics Commission - August 26, 2026

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=tokIkYd5-xQ
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Target Category	muncie_city_ethics

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Municipal Meeting Summary Report

Meeting: Ethics Commission Quarterly Meeting

Date: August 26, 2026

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** Presiding officer called the rescheduled quarterly meeting of the Muncie Ethics Commission to order on August 26, 2026, at 5:30 PM in the MSD conference room.
- **Attendance:**
 - **Members Present:** Susan Dylan, Jim Low, Frank Scott, Charles (Chip) Taylor, and Sandra Whitaker.
 - **Others Present:** Brandon (legal/consulting support).
 - **Presiding Officer:** Susan Dylan (implied chair).

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** None noted in the transcript.
- **Approval of Minutes** 00:00:35: The commission reviewed and approved the minutes from the previous meeting on July 8th.

- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.
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4. Substantive Business & Board Action

- **00:01:20 Further Action on Ethics Complaint EC 26-01**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Frank Scott / Chip Taylor.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Commissioners discussed the investigation into complaint EC 26-01, conducted between July 9th and August 19th. Investigators reported that despite multiple attempts over a span of nearly two months, they were unable to contact the complainant to secure evidence substantiating a code violation. The commission noted that certain aspects of the original complaint, even taken at face value, did not constitute violations of the ethics ordinance.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:**
 - Motion to accept the investigation report: **Approved via Roll Call Vote** (Susan Dylan: Yes, Jim Low: Yes, Frank Scott: Yes, Charles Taylor: Yes, Sandra Whitaker: Yes).
 - Motion to dismiss complaint EC 26-01 pursuant to Section 42.01D4 (stating the complaint does not allege sufficient facts to determine a violation): **Approved via Roll Call Vote** (Frank Scott: Yes, Chip Taylor: Yes, Sandra Whitaker: Yes).
 - **00:07:37 Old Business: Transparency Portal Updates**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Chip Taylor.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Chip Taylor presented a comprehensive report detailing improvements to the city's transparency portal. The report extracts information from Board of Public Works and Safety minutes, purchasing documents, and invoices (primarily from police and fire departments). The system is approximately 85% automated via AI extraction, organizing purchases by department and meeting date, and providing clickable links to source PDF documents (designating whether contracts are signed or unsigned). The commission praised department cooperation—specifically calling out Gretchen in Community Development, Deputy Chief in the Fire Department, and City Clerk Blend Mson—noting that the user-friendly reporting format significantly reduces redundant records requests.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational report; no formal board action required.
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5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

No open public comment period or general citizen forum was held during this meeting.

6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements 00:22:29:**
 - **Professional Development:** The commission discussed incorporating a brief educational segment into future meetings regarding confidentiality and the step-by-step complaint process.
 - **Upcoming Schedule:** Due to a schedule adjustment around Veterans Day (moving away from November 11th), the next regular quarterly meeting is scheduled for **November 4, 2026, at 5:30 PM**, with subsequent focus turning toward drafting the annual report.
- **Adjournment 00:28:52:** A motion and second were made to adjourn the meeting.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.

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